The C# constructs shown in this section can be useful, but they can make your templates harder to read. It's generally easier to understand the intention of Razor templates that are predominantly HTML markup rather than C#.

In the previous version of ASP.NET, these constructs, and in particular the `Html` helper property, were the standard way to generate dynamic markup. You can still use this approach in ASP.NET Core by using the various `HtmlHelper` methods on the `Html` property, but these have largely been superseded by a cleaner technique: Tag Helpers.

NOTE I discuss Tag Helpers and how to use them to build HTML forms in chapter 18. `HtmlHelper` is essentially obsolete, though it's still available if you prefer to use it.

Tag Helpers are a useful feature that's new to Razor in ASP.NET Core, but many other features have been carried through from the legacy (.NET Framework) ASP.NET. In the next section of this chapter, you'll see how you can create nested Razor templates and use partial views to reduce the amount of duplication in your views.

17.4 Layouts, partial views, and _ViewStart

In this section you'll learn about layouts and partial views, which allow you to extract common code to reduce duplication. These files make it easier to make changes to your HTML that affect multiple pages at once. You'll also learn how to run common code for every Razor Page using _ViewStart and _ViewImports, and how to include optional sections in your pages.

Every HTML document has a certain number of elements that are required: `<html>`, `<head>`, and `<body>`. As well, there are often common sections that are repeated on every page of your application, such as the header